

BEFORE YOU OPEN ANYTHING

Read me first

What you have just downloaded, and how to open it.

What is in the folder

Folder	What is in it
01_START_HERE	This page, and the illustrated quick-start guide.
02_EXCEL	The workbook for Microsoft Excel.
03_GOOGLE_SHEETS	The workbook prepared for Google Sheets, and how to import it.
04_LICENSE	What you may and may not do with it.
05_SUPPORT	Questions people ask, and the record of changes.

Getting the files out

1 Unzip the download first

On Windows, right-click the .zip and choose Extract All. On a Mac, double-click it. Do not try to open the workbook from inside the zip — it will open read-only and nothing you type will be saved.

2 Open the edition you use

Excel: open **Christmas_Master_Command_Center_Excel.xlsx** from 02_EXCEL. Google Sheets: follow the short instructions in 03_GOOGLE_SHEETS.

3 Save your own copy before you type

File, Save As, and give it this year's name. Keep the original untouched — next December you will want a clean one.

4 Go to START HERE inside the workbook

It is the second tab. Six steps, and you are planning.

What it works in

Where	What to expect
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Microsoft Excel on Windows or Mac (Microsoft 365, 2021, 2019)	Everything: formulas, dropdowns, the two charts, protection, print set-up.
Google Sheets	Formulas, dropdowns, filters and formatting. Some Excel-only details change on import — 03_GOOGLE_SHEETS lists them plainly.
Excel or Sheets on a phone or tablet	Readable, and fine for ticking something off. Setting up on a small screen is hard work; do that on a computer.
Apple Numbers, LibreOffice, WPS	Not tested. They may open the file and may lose formatting or formulas. We cannot support them.

No macros, no add-ins, no sign-in. This is an ordinary spreadsheet file. It does not send anything anywhere, and it does not need an internet connection to work.

What you type into it

The workbook sits on your own device or your own drive. It is not encrypted, and anyone who can open the file can read everything in it. Keep sizes, preferences and hiding places here — that is what it is for. Keep card numbers, passwords and identity documents somewhere else.

If something is wrong

If a file will not open or a figure looks wrong, message Mlissia through your order on Etsy and say which edition you are using and which sheet the problem is on. Support covers the files as delivered: opening them, missing files, and errors in the workbook itself. It does not cover teaching Excel or Google Sheets from scratch, customisations you have made, or software we have not tested.